

Soren Underhill

Character Dossier

Fiercely protective of newcomers bookbinder of the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light

Overview

Soren Underhill is a bookbinder living in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light. Soren is 50 years old, originally from Whitmoor, and is known around the big top as fiercely protective of newcomers. In conversation Soren refuses to say the word 'no' outright.

Background

Soren arrived in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light 14 years ago after leaving Whitmoor under circumstances Soren describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Ringmaster's troupe; the second was the one that stuck. Today Soren works as a bookbinder near the menagerie wagons and is paid, when paid at all, in copper bits.

Soren learned the trade from Leocadia Hartwell, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Soren's life is with Fitzgerald Kaldwin, over a matter neither will explain. The person Soren trusts most is Thaddeus Grimsby.

Current goal: to earn the title of master before turning fifty. Greatest fear: birds indoors.

Personality and speech

Temperament: fiercely protective of newcomers.

Speech pattern: Soren refuses to say the word 'no' outright.

Tells: when lying, Soren mentions Ollie the cat for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Soren Underhill
Role	bookbinder
Home	the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light
Hometown	Whitmoor
Age	50
Favourite dish	the tavern's lentil fritters
Pet	Ollie, a cat
Lucky number	259

<i>Workshop password</i>	lattice-cove
<i>Mentor</i>	Leocadia Hartwell
<i>Rival</i>	Fitzgerald Kaldwin
<i>Closest friend</i>	Thaddeus Grimsby

Secret

Soren owes Fitzgerald Kaldwin a debt of 86 copper bits that neither of them mentions.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Soren: I am the bookbinder. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Soren: The tavern's lentil fritters. Do not tell Fitzgerald I said so.

Visitor: Is Ollie yours?

Soren: Ollie belongs to nobody. Ollie tolerates me. Lucky number is 259, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 25

Octavia came by asking about the quarantine. Soren said nothing useful and made tea instead. Jasper came by asking about the census. Soren said nothing useful and made tea instead. Juniper came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Soren said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the quarantine. Soren read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Soren found a bundle of letters half-buried near the menagerie wagons and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 2, autumn of year 25

the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the quarantine. Soren read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rosalind came by asking about who really won the regatta. Soren said nothing useful and made tea instead. Soren was hired to carry a spool of wire from the menagerie wagons to the cookfire without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Dorothea came by asking about who really won the regatta. Soren said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 3, spring of year 25

The weather turned. Soren moved the oilskin map indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the right way to mend a net. Soren was hired to carry a iron kettle from the big top to the menagerie wagons without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Soren repaired the hand bell at the big top for Fitzgerald, who paid in 54 copper bits and a long story about the right way to mend a net. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Soren has a suspect and is probably right. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 4, autumn of year 25

Soren closed early, walked to the menagerie wagons, and watched the lights come on. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Soren and a neighbour outside the cookfire; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about the comet reached the cookfire. Soren pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 5, autumn of year 25

Soren won 61 copper bits on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before. Ravi came by asking about the comet. Soren said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zora came by asking about the new curfew. Soren said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 6, summer of year 25

the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the quarantine. Soren read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the ticket wagon, Soren taught a newcomer how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a iron kettle on the doorstep with no note. Soren

has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 7, summer of year 25

Soren found a glass float half-buried near the costume tent and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Soren and a neighbour outside the costume tent; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the costume tent, Soren taught a newcomer how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone. Soren repaired the bundle of letters at the costume tent for Viggo, who paid in 61 copper bits and a long story about who really won the regatta.

Entry 8, winter of year 25

At the menagerie wagons, Soren taught a newcomer how to tell a real iron kettle from a fake one by weight alone. Soren spent the day counting stock at the menagerie wagons: 4 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short. Soren won 85 copper bits on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on supper. Soren was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the menagerie wagons to the cookfire without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 9, spring of year 25

Soren spent the day counting stock at the big top: 52 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Soren closed early, walked to the cookfire, and watched the lights come on. Soren spent the day counting stock at the big top: 63 of everything, except the bundle of letters, which is always short. Soren closed early, walked to the cookfire, and watched the lights come on. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Soren and a neighbour outside the big top; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 10, spring of year 25

Soren repaired the clockwork bird at the menagerie wagons for Isadora, who paid in 67 copper bits and a long story about the quarantine. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Soren read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Soren found a grain scale half-buried near the menagerie wagons and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a oilskin map on the doorstep with no note. Soren has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 11, autumn of year 25

Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached the ticket wagon. Soren pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Soren closed early, walked to the menagerie wagons, and watched the lights come on. Soren was hired to carry a spool of wire from the ticket wagon to the menagerie wagons without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Soren spent the day counting stock at the ticket wagon: 9 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. The weather turned. Soren moved the wax seal indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew.